Research Statement

Vittoria Iannotta
PhD Candidate in Economics, HEC Paris

I am a researcher working in macro-finance and banking. I study how banks and firms interact in the market for credit: what determines loan pricing, how credit is allocated across firms, and how monetary policy affects equilibrium outcomes. My investigation starts from an empirical fact: observationally equivalent firms in terms of credit quality do not pay the same rates for similar loans; my research shows that this is true when firms borrow from different banks, or even when they borrow from the same bank. Understanding these rate differentials matters because they have implications for regulation and monetary-policy transmission, as well as for firms' investment and growth.

The question that organizes my work is how much of the price a firm pays reflects what its lender knows about the true credit quality of the firm, and how much reflects how little competition that bank faces. The question is hard because the two forces are not independent. A bank prices on what it learns only to the extent that rivals cannot undercut it, and it pays to learn only when the rents from screening survive competition. Information and competition therefore jointly determine the rate a firm is quoted, which firms are offered credit at all, how the surplus from a lending relationship is divided, and how monetary policy passes through to firms. Studying either force in isolation misreads all four outcomes. In my work, I address this question from several perspectives, combining French administrative loan-level data with equilibrium models of loan pricing under search frictions and asymmetric information.

Default-risk surprises and banks' loan pricing. In my job-market paper, I rationalize interest-rate differentials across observationally equivalent firms by combining empirical evidence and a structural model. I show that jointly considering what banks know about borrowers' credit quality and the degree of competition among banks is key to understanding the observed rate dispersion. The European Central Bank awarded this paper its **2026 Lamfalussy Fellowship**.

I start by documenting new empirical facts: interest-rate differentials across similar firms borrowing similar loan products from the same bank contain information on future changes in firms' default risk. I merge rich administrative loan-level data with public ratings from the Banque de France — a sufficient statistic for creditworthiness — to map rating classes to default probabilities and to track the evolution of firms' default probability after loan issuance. A firm whose probability of default increases by 1 percentage point after one year paid, on average, a 0.04 percentage point premium at issuance; the premium doubles for young and small firms, is larger at long maturities, and peaks in 2009–2012. I rule out the reverse channel by comparing fixed- and variable-rate borrowers over a period when reference rates rose: a more expensive loan does not cause the firm's rating to deteriorate. This is suggestive evidence that banks know more than the econometrician, but information cannot be the whole story. Imperfect competition can generate the same patterns, and the literature commonly attributes loan-rate dispersion to it (Amiti, Kashyap and Kovner 2026; Bocola, Bornstein and Puglisi 2026; Cavalcanti, Kaboski, Martins and Santos 2023; Ferreira and Kozeniauskas 2026).

To tease out the forces at play in the data, I develop a model of loan pricing that combines search frictions, which generate imperfect competition between banks, with asymmetric information about firms' risk types. I introduce an imperfect public signal of firms' risk types into

the price-dispersion framework of Varian (1980) and Burdett and Judd (1983), building on the approach of Lester, Shourideh, Venkateswaran and Zetlin-Jones (2019). I model banks as sorting borrowers through the interest rates they offer, the instrument I observe in the data, and a public signal that provides an imperfect indication of firms' types, rather than relying on price-quantity menus. This formulation allows me to incorporate asymmetric information while retaining a framework that can be taken directly to the data. The signal allows banks to sort borrowers, while search limits firms' ability to arbitrage away differences in borrowing costs. In equilibrium, the positive rate-risk relationship arises for two reasons: a signal precise enough to separate borrowers, or — with no information at all — search frictions that lead banks to randomize between pooling borrowers and inducing self-selection through pricing. By calibrating the model to the data, I show that both information and search are necessary to account for the empirical patterns. I find that, in safer markets, banks are informed and separate borrowers; in riskier ones, they are uninformed and pool borrowers.

Expanding the analysis to the euro area. An important direction of my research agenda is to overcome the data limitations of my job-market paper by seeking access to the euro-area credit registry, AnaCredit. My current measure of bank information relies on public ratings, which biases it in a known direction: I observe a realized outcome, not the bank's expectation at issuance. If banks are right on average, the realized outcome adds noise that is uncorrelated with the rate, so the approach *understates* how much rates reflect what banks know. Observing banks' own internal ratings would close that gap. This also raises a question worth asking in its own right: are internal ratings accurate in measuring expected default risk, or do they respond to other needs related to capital requirements and regulation? I plan to test how precisely internal ratings assigned at issuance predict realized default. AnaCredit provides the natural setting to explore this question: it records internal ratings alongside loan terms, the full bank–firm exposure history and default outcomes, none of which survey data provide. Moreover, my framework enables cross-country comparisons of monetary-policy pass-through and their policy implications. The model predicts that transmission is impaired by low competition, but also affects banks' strategies to pool borrowers or price safer firms out of the market. Country-specific differences can thus be interpreted through differences in signal precision and the degree of competition.

When lenders disagree. In ongoing work, I extend the theoretical framework of my job-market paper to understand endogenous information acquisition under asymmetric information and imperfect competition. Unlike my job-market paper, where all banks observe a common signal, here each bank independently chooses its screening precision, drawing a signal that is independent of its rival's conditional on the firm's type, as in Broecker (1990). With respect to the common signal case, this framework introduces disagreement between banks about firms' true quality. A bank that drew a good signal may be bidding against a rival that drew a bad one, and each signal's rate distribution therefore depends on the other's. In equilibrium, the two signals sort across the rate range: banks that drew a good signal post the lowest rates in the market, banks that drew a bad signal the highest. Banks may post in the pooling region only, or separate when banks observing a bad signal post high rates that only risky firms accept; the outcome is summarized by one index of the degree of adverse selection. My main result concerns the value of information. Wherever the rate ranges associated with the two signals overlap, an uninformed bank can match an informed bank's profits by posting the same rate regardless of its signal. Therefore, assuming a positive and increasing cost of information, only two market configurations survive: banks remain uninformed, or become informed when the two signals' rate ranges are disjoint. This sharpens Hauswald and Marquez (2003, 2006), who find that competition erodes the return to screening, into the statement that no interior precision is an equilibrium. This result rationalizes why the calibration in my job-market paper

places banks at the two corners, informed in the safe rating classes and uninformed in the risky ones.

Lender heterogeneity in the pricing of bundled credit. In an ongoing project I turn to an understudied dimension of bank pricing: how lenders price multiple credit products issued to the same firm at the same time. Standard arguments suggest that banks may discount bundled credit to attract new borrowers, strengthen lending relationships, or exploit economies of scope in borrower screening and monitoring. Yet these mechanisms do not explain why some lenders charge a premium while others offer a discount. Using French administrative loan-level survey data, I document substantial heterogeneity in the pricing of bundled credit. The average bundle pricing gap is close to zero, at -0.05 percentage points, but masks a dispersion of 1.69 percentage points across lenders. Among 99 lenders, 19 charge statistically significant premiums, 15 offer statistically significant discounts, and the remainder exhibit no statistically significant pricing gap. This heterogeneity is not explained by borrower composition or product mix, which account for only 0.6% and 4.9%, respectively, of cross-lender variation. Moreover, bundle pricing does not systematically differ for first-time borrowers, defined as firms with no recorded lending relationship with the bank in preceding quarters. These findings suggest that lender-specific pricing strategies, rather than observable differences in borrowers or bundled products, are central to understanding the pricing of bundled credit.

I am developing the analysis along two dimensions. First, I investigate whether lenders use bundles to screen borrowers with different risk profiles, inducing firms to self-select into bundles with different prices. Second, I examine the role of market power and banks' ability to price-discriminate across borrowers. Together, these mechanisms may explain why the pricing of bundled credit varies substantially across lenders, even when differences in borrower composition and product mix account for little of the observed heterogeneity.

Taken together, my research studies how information and competition shape the pricing and allocation of credit. I examine how lenders' private information, market power, and strategic choices generate differences among firms in loan rates, credit access, and monetary-policy transmission. Going forward, I aim to combine richer loan-level data with equilibrium models of information acquisition and competition to understand how information sharing, market structure, and lender organization shape credit markets. Ultimately, I seek to distinguish when credit-market dispersion reflects valuable information and when it reflects market power.

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